tary effort, which is supported in no way by the State, this is remarkable, and most of the persons who learn Hindi themselves become missionaries in the cause.

I have no doubt whatever that Hindustani is going to be the common language of India. Indeed it is largely so to-day for ordinary purposes. Its progress has been hampered by foolish controversies about the script, *nāgri* or Persian, and by the misdirected efforts of the two factions to use language which is either too Sanskritised or too Persianised. There is no way out of the script difficulty, for it arouses great heat and passion, except to adopt both officially, and allow people to use either. But an effort must be made to discourage the extreme tendencies and develop a middle literary language, on the lines of the spoken language in common use. With mass education this will inevitably take place. At present the small middle-class groups, that are supposed to be the arbiters of literary taste and style, are terribly narrow-minded and conservative, each in its own way. They cling to antique forms that have no life in them and have few contacts with their own masses or with world literature.

The development and spread of Hindustani must not and will not conflict with the continued use and enrichment of the other great languages of India—Bengali, Gujrati, Marathi, Oriya and the Dravidian languages of the south. Some of these languages are already more wide-awake and intellectually alert than Hindustani, and they must remain the official languages for educational and other purposes in their respective areas.

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or the previous one of 1921. I imagine they refer to the latter, and up-to-date figures would show a considerable increase under each head.

Hindustani (including western Hindi, Punjabi and Rajasthani)	139.3	millions
Bengali	49.3	„
Telegu	23.6	„
Marathi	18.8	„
Tamil	18.8	„
Canarese	10.3	„
Oriya	10.1	„
Gujrati	9.6	„
Total	279.8	„

Some languages like Pushtu, Assamese and, of couse, Burmese, which is entirely different, linguistically and territorially, have been omitted from this list.